

Jacob Peel

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Human-Computer Interaction MSc graduate providing IxD and research expertise, and technical CS background.

QUALIFICATIONS

Newcastle University

Human-Computer Interaction MSc

December 2025

- Merit

Computer Science BSc

July 2024

- Upper Second-Class Honours

Cockermouth School & 6th form

A Level

August 2021

- Computer Science A*, History A*, Psychology A

GCSE

August 2019

- 7 A*, 2 A, 1 C including A* Graphic Communications, Computer Science

BACKGROUND

HCI MSc

September 2024 – September 2025

- Collaborated on numerous varied projects with diverse teams from brief to deliverable and report, including design and development of many user-centred tools using wireframing, Figma, frontend development etc.
- Conversely often worked independently, like in dissertation project requiring rigorous research, design and analysis across multiple months, utilising iterative feedback from well-regarded academic to deliver academic paper.
- Frequently utilised research methods, particularly surveys and interviews, both quantitative and qualitative.
- Conducted usability evaluation through cooperative evaluation method with users, identifying issues and severity.
- Consistently utilised industry-standard IxD methods like sketching, storyboarding, workshopping and UI design.
- Hands-on experience with prototyping and development of physical tools using electronics and construction in lab.
- Applied Responsible Research and Innovation (RRI) tenets in design, like anticipating environmental impacts.
- Regularly gave presentations and wrote reflective reports, revealing critique to end of improving proficiency.

Computer Science BSc

September 2021 – May 2024

- Strong technical background, having learnt software development skills like programming (see “Technologies”).
- Consistently managed time and workload towards deadlines, achieving 0 late submissions.
- Practice of frontend development, both as skill useful in technical prototyping, and informing design thinking.
- Wrote HCI dissertation (15000 words), following a user-centred design methodology for a nutrition planner app.
- Frequent use of version-control software (GitHub) to manage versioning and collaboration.
- Understanding and usage of different software development methodologies, like waterfall and agile.

Head of Digital Communications

September 2023 – August 2025

Newcastle University Fellwalking Society

- Managed Instagram, Facebook and WhatsApp presence to attract ~500 paid members, inform them effectively, and promote ~40 sold-out events at ~20-75 tickets each.
- Utilised graphic design, photography, curation and copywriting skills to create ~200 informative and engaging posts, both advertising trips and later showcasing them for member enrichment and to enhance public perception.
- Reworked and managed nufws.com, a WordPress site that was frequently updated with trip details as posts.
- Sustained communications when Instagram removed due to false flag, resolving this though deemed irreparable.
- Rebranded society twice, dictating usage of font, logo, colour and textures within social media communications.
- Handled large frequency of member queries, including maintaining trip reserve lists to fill 100% of late vacancies.
- Won “Society of The Year 2024”, wherein social media was a primary reference for Student’s Union judges.
- Led mountainous walks, navigating and considering others’ safety and wellbeing, showing authority and initiative.

Head of Branding

September 2019 – March 2020

Cockermouth School Young Enterprise

- Solely responsible for branding in functional organisation structure, cooperating with other departments and CEO.
- Organisation manufactured and sold wooden educational toy, providing understanding of ethical business practice.

- Graphic design and copywriting skill refined in professional setting, creating logos, documentation, and packaging.
- Worked from brand conception to product delivery, increasing familiarity with commercialisation lifecycle.

Kitchen Porter

Summer 2023

The Old Mill Inn, Dearham

- Learned teamwork skills in fast-paced environment, following instructions from seniors.
- Showed resilience working long shifts on feet doing repetitive and physically demanding work.

SKILLS & INTERESTS

- **Technologies:** Figma, Photoshop, Canva, NVivo, MERN stack, Miro, JavaScript, C, Python, Java, C#, CSS/HTML
- **Skills:** UI/UX design/prototyping, user research, frontend development, backend development, digital communications, graphic design, copywriting, collaboration on projects, adaptability, working to deadlines.
- **Interests:** Hillwalking, camping, boxing, literature, running, meditation, cooking, gym etc.